

100 Days of Linux - Day 049

Title: Job Control with jobs, fg, and bg

Today's Goal

Learn how to pause, resume, and manage jobs running from your current terminal.

Why This Matters

Long-running scripts, downloads, and data processing tasks often need to run in the background while you continue working.

Commands of the Day

jobs - List background and stopped jobs

fg %job_number - Bring a job to the foreground

bg %job_number - Resume a stopped job in the background

Keyboard Shortcuts:

Ctrl+Z = Suspend the current foreground process

Ctrl+C = Stop the current process

Example Workflow:

```
sleep 300
```

```
Ctrl+Z
```

```
jobs
```

```
bg %1
```

```
fg %1
```

Beginner Lesson

A job is a process started from your current terminal. Linux lets you pause it, move it to the background, and bring it back whenever you need.

Practice Questions

1. Run 'sleep 300', then pause it using Ctrl+Z.
2. Use the jobs command to display the suspended job.
3. Resume the suspended job in the background using bg.
4. Bring the background job back to the foreground using fg, then stop it with Ctrl+C.
5. Display your current working directory.

Hints

Ctrl+Z pauses a process. The jobs command shows the job number, which is used with fg and bg.

Mini Challenge

Start two separate sleep commands. Pause both, send both to the background, list them with jobs, then bring each one back to the foreground and stop it.

Common Mistakes

Using a PID with fg or bg. These commands use job numbers such as %1, not process IDs.

Did You Know?

Job control is handled by the shell, which is why jobs, fg, and bg only work for processes started from your current terminal session.

Pro Tip

Use bg to keep a long-running command active while you continue working in the same terminal.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: sleep 300 then press Ctrl+Z

Q2: jobs

Q3: bg %1

Q4: fg %1 then Ctrl+C

Q5: pwd

Homework

Practice starting, pausing, resuming, and stopping several jobs until the workflow feels natural.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll complete the Processes module with a practical assignment combining ps, top, htop, kill, jobs, fg, and bg.